

Target Recon

CompTIA PenTest+ (PT0-003)

Domain:

- 2.0: Reconnaissance and Enumeration

Objectives:

- 2.1: Given a scenario, apply information gathering techniques.
- 2.2: Given a scenario, apply enumeration techniques.

Video Overview

This video provides an overview of target reconnaissance within the context of penetration testing. It explains the importance of gathering intelligence about a target through passive means, focusing on how this information contributes to understanding potential vulnerabilities. The material presented is relevant for students pursuing the PenTest+ certification and careers in IT security, offering practical insights into initial assessment phases.

Key Topics Covered

- **Passive Reconnaissance:** Gathering intelligence about a target using freely available information without direct interaction.
- **Technical, Administrative, and General Contacts:** Identifying key personnel and their roles using tools like WHOIS and NSLOOKUP, and publicly available company information.
- **Social Media and OSINT (Open Source Intelligence):** Utilizing social media platforms and other open sources to uncover details about individuals and organizations.
- **Job Listings:** Analyzing job postings on company websites and job boards to identify technology stacks and gain insight into the target's infrastructure.
- **Cryptographic Flaws:** Examining encryption types, TLS certificates, and potential weaknesses (e.g., expired certificates, older SSL/TLS versions).
- **Public Data:** Discovering information from data dumps, password lists, cryptocurrency transactions, and file metadata.
- **Strategic Search Engine Analysis (Google Dorks):** Employing specialized search queries to find sensitive information or vulnerabilities.

- **Reconnaissance Tools:** Introduction to key tools such as Have I Been Pwned, Metagoofil, The Harvester, Wayback Machine, Shodan, GitHub, and Recon-NG.

Student Notes Section